Digital Literacy Portfolio:

Project Report Name: Aditya Namdev

Reg No.: 25BCE10297

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Introduction As a newly selected Student Digital Ambassador, the objective of this project was to build a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio to assist my peers in navigating the digital landscape safely and professionally. This report documents the completion of five core tasks designed to establish a foundational understanding of digital tools and etiquette. The scenario required the practical application of concepts ranging from visual communication and professional networking to coding platforms, email etiquette, and cybercrime awareness. By working through these modules, I have curated a GitHub repository that not only serves as the deliverable for this project but also acts as the groundwork for my ongoing professional digital presence throughout my engineering degree.

Task 1 Write-up For this task, I created a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic aimed at helping my batchmates understand essential digital practices. I chose to use Canva to design the infographic because of its intuitive drag-and-drop interface and excellent educational templates. The design highlights three main areas: the importance of a professional online presence, basic email etiquette rules for contacting professors, and essential safe internet practices like avoiding public Wi-Fi for transactions. One thing I found particularly interesting while making it was the challenge of visual hierarchy—distilling complex advice into very short, digestible bullet points without losing the core message was harder than I anticipated. Ultimately, the visual format makes the information much more accessible than a text-heavy document.

Task 2 Write-up To establish my professional digital footprint, I set up profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. I chose GitHub because it is the industry standard for version control and hosting software projects; I created a profile README to introduce myself as a B.Tech student eager to learn. I chose LinkedIn to build a professional network, filling in my education details at VIT Bhopal to connect with alumni and recruiters. Finally, I set up Kaggle to prepare for future data science and machine learning competitions. Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to host all my coding assignments and personal projects, use LinkedIn to document my internships and academic milestones, and use Kaggle to actively practice my analytical skills.

Task 3 Write-up To build familiarity with coding and collaboration tools, I utilized HackerRank and Google Workspace. On HackerRank, I created an account and completed the introductory "Solve Me First" challenge, which helped me understand the platform's input/output testing environment. For collaboration, I built a 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz' using Google Forms, featuring multiple-choice and short-answer questions. These tools will be incredibly helpful academically; HackerRank provides a structured way to practice data structures and algorithms outside of class, which is vital for placements. Meanwhile, mastering Google Forms and Sheets will allow me to easily gather data for group projects, organize club events, or conduct peer surveys seamlessly.

Task 4 Write-up This task focused on professional digital communication. I drafted two emails—one requesting a deadline extension and another inquiring about an internship—and created a social media conduct checklist. A key learning was understanding that a poorly structured digital message can have real-world consequences. For example, if a student sends a frustrated, informal email to a professor demanding a grade change without proper salutations or context, the professor might interpret it as disrespectful, potentially damaging that academic relationship permanently. What should have been done differently is taking a step back to ensure the tone was objective, the request was polite, and standard professional formatting was applied before hitting send.

Task 5 Write-up For the cybercrime module, I researched UPI payment fraud and created a prevention checklist for college students. What surprised me most while researching this topic was how cybercriminals use psychological manipulation—creating a false sense of urgency or excitement about a "cashback"—to bypass technical security measures. The fact that victims willingly enter their own PINs because they are confused about the interface is alarming. As a result of this research, one habit I will personally change is my approach to incoming payment requests; I will institute a strict "pause and verify" rule before interacting with any unknown financial notifications, and I will double-check that my PIN is only ever used to send money, never to receive it.

Conclusion Overall, this project provided a highly practical introduction to the digital skills required for a successful academic and professional career. Transitioning from theoretical concepts to hands-on applications—like configuring a GitHub repository, writing formal internship inquiries, and analyzing real-world cyber threats—has significantly boosted my confidence. I now feel adequately prepared to manage my digital footprint responsibly and to assist my peers as a Digital Ambassador.

References

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